Drive types – pros and cons

This month, **Philip Greenwood** looks at the pros and cons of drive types

You may ask how many drive types are there? 'A lot' is the short answer. Which type of drive you use depends on a few factors: this can include the size of timber being turned and whether it is dry or wet wood. Wet timber can affect which drive type you use due to the timber fibres being more flexible, which means the drive centre may not grip as well with some types. Be aware that wet timber, which has tanning acid in it, can turn the timber around the drive centre position black if the drive centre is made of steel.

PHILIP GREENWOOD

Philip has been woodturning since 1980 and started turning professionally in 1986. He was accepted onto The Register of Professional Turners in 2006. He is a member of the AWGB and AAW. He can be seen working in his workshop in North Yorkshire with many of his items on display. From here he runs courses and he also demonstrates at clubs around the UK.

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4-PRONG CENTRES

A 4-prong centre is the most common drive centre; this is normally the one that comes with a lathe as standard. The most common 4-prong centres come in 1 and 2 Morse tapers for woodturning lathes. As the name implies, it has four prongs. This is used to drive a square piece of timber between centres. This can be used in both wet and dry timber.

PHOTOGRAPHS BY WENDY GREENWOOD

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